

Flies

There's no escaping them – flies are all over the place. Lots of people hate them because many spread diseases and a lot of them bite. But flies have their uses and we couldn't live without them.

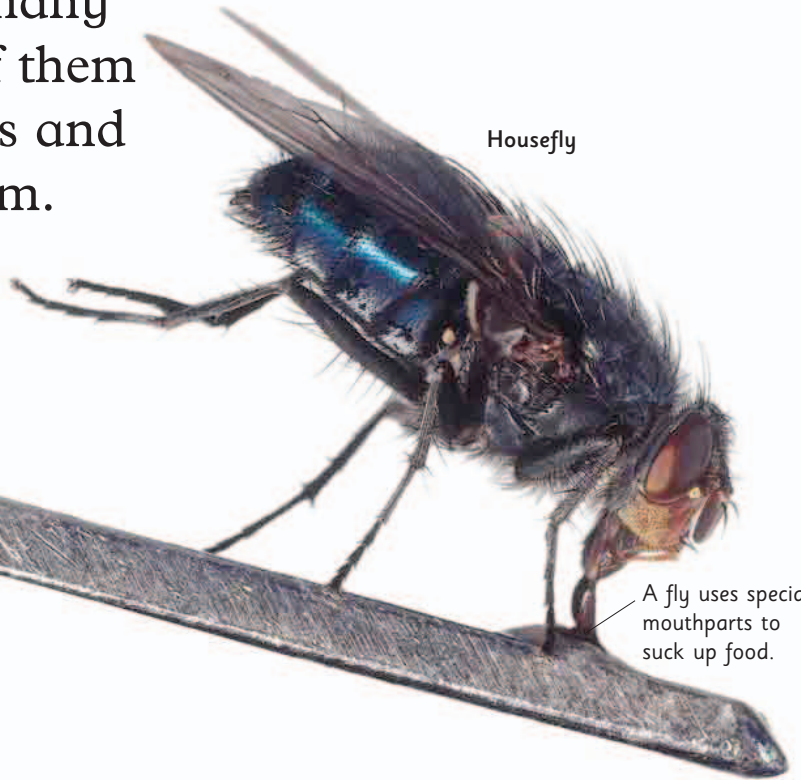
Disease carriers

Flies like rotting food and their sticky feet can carry bacteria from one piece of food to another, which can spread nasty diseases.



Housefly

A fly vomits on food to turn it to liquid, and then sucks it up.



A fly uses special mouthparts to suck up food.

Fly babies

Flies often lay their eggs, which hatch into maggots, in manure or rubbish. Unlike adults, maggots do not have wings and they chew rotten food rather than suck it up. They eventually turn into pupas, then flies, just like caterpillars turn into butterflies or moths.



Maggots

Turn and learn

Other pests:
pp. 116-117
Metamorphosis
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Flight

Flies are very good flyers, which is why they are difficult to swat. This hoverfly can beat its wings up to 1,000 times per second!

Sometimes it changes direction so quickly that it seems to disappear.

